

MEDICARE CONNECT (PTY) LTD
POPIA BREACH NOTIFICATION PROCEDURE
POPIA Section 22 Compliance | 72-Hour Notification Guide
Classification: Confidential
Version: 1.0
Date: March 2026
Owner: Information Officer
Prepared by: Patrick Mohlala, GRC Analyst

When This Procedure Activates

This procedure activates the moment a security incident is confirmed to involve unauthorised access to, or loss of, personal information belonging to patients or staff.

Do not wait for a full investigation.

The 72-hour clock starts at discovery, not at confirmation.

If In Doubt: Start The Clock.

You can cancel a notification. You cannot reverse a missed deadline.

Step-By-Step 72-Hour Procedure

Hour 0 Breach Discovered

- Record exact time of discovery

Date : _____ Time: _____

- Notify Information Officer immediately

- Information Officer notifies CEO

- Record 72-hour deadline

Deadline Date: _____ Time: _____

- Open incident log: INC-_____

- Begin documenting all actions

HOURL 0 TO 4 – INITIAL ASSESSMENT

The Information Officer leads this phase.

- What personal information was affected? (tick all that apply)

- Patient names and contact details

- Patient ID numbers

- Medical diagnoses and history

- Medication and prescription data

- Financial and billing records

- Staff personal information

- Login credentials

- How many data subjects are affected?

Approximate number : _____

- Is the breach ongoing or contained?

Status : _____

- What is the likely cause?

Cause : _____

- What harm could affected persons suffer?

- Financial loss

- Identity theft

- Discrimination
 - Physical harm
 - Reputational damage
 - Emotional distress
- Has the breach been contained?
YES / NO
If NO: Containment is priority, but notification deadline still applies.

HOURL 4 TO 24 – PREPARE NOTIFICATION

- Open pre-populated Form 4 template
- Complete incident-specific fields only
- CEO reviews and signs off
- Legal counsel reviews if available
- Save completed form with timestamp
- Draft data subject notification letter

HOURL 24 TO 72 – SUBMIT NOTIFICATION

- Submit Form 4 to Information Regulator

EMAIL: info regulator@info regulator.org.za

SUBJECT: POPIA Section 22 Breach Notification – MediCare Connect – [Date] – INC-[Number]

- Request delivery confirmation
- Save confirmation email as evidence
- Record submission:

Submitted by:	:	_____
Date and time	:	_____
Confirmation received	:	_____
- Notify affected data subjects as soon as reasonably possible

DATA SUBJECT NOTIFICATION TEMPLATE

Dear [Patient Name],

We are writing to inform you of a security incident at MediCare Connect that may have affected your personal information.

WHAT HAPPENED:

[Brief description of the breach]

WHAT INFORMATION WAS AFFECTED:

[List the categories of information]

WHAT WE HAVE DONE:

[Describe containment and remediation]

WHAT YOU SHOULD DO:

- Monitor your accounts for unusual activity
- Change passwords if credentials may have been affected
- Be alert for suspicious emails or calls
- Contact us with any concerns

HOW TO CONTACT US:

Information Officer	:	[Name]
Email	:	[Email]
Telephone	:	[Number]

We sincerely apologise for this incident and remain committed to protecting your personal information.

[CEO Name]

[CEO Title]

MediCare Connect (Pty) Ltd

AFTER NOTIFICATION

- Update POPIA breach register
- Cooperate with Information Regulator
- Provide progress updates as requested
- Preserve all evidence
- Do not destroy any records
- Continue post-incident review process
- Update risk register within 7 days

POPIA BREACH REGISTER (minimum fields)

- Incident ID
- Date
- Nature of breach
- No. of subjects
- Reported to Regulator
- Date reported
- Deadline met
- Outcome
- Actions taken

Document Control

Owner	: Information Officer
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